2001, with the understanding that his stay would be extended since the Transit Hostel always remained half-empty. But this was not the end of his troubles.

The communal-minded students who had made Qays's life so difficult in Jubilee Hall made a public issue of him having been given accommodation in the Transit Hostel which is primarily for teachers. Then, the infamous attack on the Parliament happened, and the following day, 14 December 2001, S.A.R. Geelani was arrested in connection with the attack (according to the prosecution, he was arrested on 15 December).

In the days that followed, the media, both print and electronic, abdicated its role of acting as the fourth estate.[2] Geelani was publicly tried by the media on the basis of police statements. Even before his trial began, the media had pronounced him guilty. Within three days, the Jubilee Hall students who had been targeting Qays also came up with 'information' insinuating Geelani's 'international connections' and their 'relevance' to the Parliament attack case. They suggested this by talking of Geelani's friendship with Qays and their long phone calls to destinations in West Asia.[3]

These insinuations—friendship between a Jordanian student and a Kashmiri Muslim (now facing a show trial on a charge of 'terrorism') and therefore the latter's 'connections' in the Arab world—fitted well with the attempts of the investigating agencies and the media to create a 'spin', made potent by the prevailing national and international climate of paranoia related to the 'global war against terror'.

Qays was forced to leave the Teachers' Transit Hostel without notice, without being given time to look for alternative accommodation. In fact, he was locked out of his room with his baggage still inside. All this was happening when he was in the submission stage of his thesis. He was detained by the CID and was called several times by the Special Cell of the Delhi Police, which was handling the Parliament attack case. University officials held back the appointment of examiners for the examination of his thesis. Qays approached a large number of teachers to help him get examiners appointed since his visa had been extended for only six months and time was running out. Meanwhile, fearing for his safety, Qays's family wanted him to return immediately (they had, the previous year, called back his younger brother who was studying mathematics at Delhi University), but Qays, having already invested more than four years in his studies, was resolute that he would return only after getting his degree. Finally, his viva voce was held in October 2002. He did extremely well in his viva and his examiners